

Xbox Interns

Summer 2026

Intern Project Plan

Welcome to Xbox! We know you have a lot of onboarding material that you're already working through to get going at Microsoft, get your paychecks and benefits sorted, and to get access to buildings and online resources. This document is hopefully the exciting part of your onboarding – learning more about the team and what you're going to be working on this summer. Please read through carefully – you'll first learn more about your project, followed by some concrete suggestions on first steps and conversations that you should plan to have with your manager to hit the ground running on your internship.

Your Project

Title

Instantly Shareable Playtest

Project Summary

The Juno team strives to reduce barriers and widen the funnel of the Xbox Ecosystem through the use of compelling new programs and business models. While focused initially at players, the mission remains equally as important for Game Creators.

In order to attract creators to the Xbox Ecosystem, it is imperative that it is as frictionless as possible for them to build, test, and ship on the Xbox Platform. Recently the **xplaytest** team within CORS has made significant strides in the testing aspect of the game developer cycle by offering a service that allows creators to easily upload (RETAIL signed) private builds of games and easily have testers able to use Garrison in order to install and test a nightly build of an unreleased game. While this significantly reduces the infrastructure burden compared to the previous sandbox testing and onerous CERT requirements to get a 'real build' on a tester's machine, it is not without its own barriers. Modern games are hundreds of GB and take significant time to download and install. Requiring a local install means that creators must acquire and provision a wide variety of hardware profiles to ensure broad compatibility. Physical device pose security risks for any lost device with the game's code locally inspectable. To solve these problems, an '**Instantly Shareable Playtest**' solution is proposed.

The **Instantly Shareable Playtest** combines the best aspects of xplaytest with the power of Xbox Cloud Gaming. Using only a shareable link, creators will enable testers to easily stream their private (though still RETAIL) builds; no install or download required.

Project Goals

The north star vision and very rough flow for this project is as follows:

1. Creators are easily able to create a playtest using the existing xplaytest portal and optionally select if they want to allow cloud streaming as a way to test.
2. Playtests with cloud streaming enabled will communicate to Xbox Game Streaming Services in order to create a private offering unique to the playtest. (A private offering is a Cloud Gaming concept that creates a streaming catalog of titles and associated metadata restricted to specific users).
3. Only users authorized for the playtest are configured for access to the Private Offering, likely through the integration of DNA group support in xCloud.
4. Whenever a new game build is published to a playtest, a workflow is created to ingest that build into game streaming services in order to be made available to the private offering. As part of the workflow, the private offering is updated to have a single title available configured for the new game build.
5. Playtesters have some way to access the content in the private offering via a link (private offering support is possible today in the web cloud streaming endpoint but not Garrison and not in perhaps the smoothest way for playtests) or having the content 'magically show up' once signed in.
6. When accessing a playtest, testers know this is a non public version of the game and as much metadata as possible (title, genre, art, etc.) that the store / playtest has is available to be seen.
7. When accessing a playtest, testers are offered the option to either install locally or stream now
8. Streaming the game allows a tester to provide feedback on the experience

OUTCOMES:

1. A new S2S endpoint and relationship is formed between Game Streaming Services and xplaytest / package publishing / partner center.
2. A new relationship / endpoint / functionality exists within catalog / Content Access / Hydration to support private offering / playtest content metadata
3. A unified experience for creators enables testing of content regardless of endpoint or local install
4. A flow exists for creators to self-serve cloud streaming metadata by being able to 'publish' a playtest

Detailed Objectives and Success Metrics		
Here are objectives that lead toward the goals above. P0s and P1s are critical to the success of the project and represent our expectations of impact for a successful internship. P2s and P3s represent additional opportunities to go further (“stretch goals”).		
Priority	Goals	Details and Success Metrics
P0	Creating a playtest creates a private offering	Private offerings are created within a few seconds of creating the playtest. Offering is visible and manageable in the DevApi Reader portal
P0	Deleting a playtest deletes any associated private offering	Private offerings are deleted within a few seconds of creating the playtest. Offering is fully cleaned up and DevApi portal no longer shows it.
P0	Private offerings created for a playtest have a unique name/id for easy handling of multiple titles / sellers	<i>Stretch Goal (P2):</i> There is some way in the DevApi Reader Portal to easily browse ‘playtest offerings’ separately from our existing offerings and filter by studio/seller/title etc.
P0	Updating the private audience access list / groups for a playtest updates the offering configuration	Changing to a different DNA group changes the configuration. Changing DNA group members automatically updates with no config needed.
P0	Creation of a private offering can be limited to a specific title / seller for internal testing	Xplaytest ‘flights’ functionality to only specific allow list of sellers to limit impact of created offerings during development
P0	Private offerings support DNA group access compatible with playtest.	All private offerings should support custom DNA groups that can be checked during offering ‘login’. Currently ‘flight’ / ‘DNA Group’ auth doesn’t show up in a user’s /offerings call. This is a problem for the UX
P0	Xplaytest portal has a link that can be shared to members of the playtest that lets them stream	Xplaytest can know the created offering details to craft a URL that is usable for streaming the game
P0	Members not part of the playtest do not see any information about the playtest when clicking the link	Bayside does not leak details about the playtest to members not in it
P0	When a new build is uploaded for a playtest that is configured for cloud, that build is ingested into Game Streaming Services	A few seconds / minutes after uploading a new build, launching streaming will use the new version of the game. Stretch Goal (P2): xplaytest portal has user

		feedback about when the build is 'ready for testing' across different endpoints
P0	When a new build is uploaded for a playtest that is configured for cloud, that build is configured to be used by the private offering	At somepoint, the offering is configured to have a title in it that matches the product id, etc. Of the uploaded build.
P1	A service (Content Access Service or GSSV) is able to inform bayside / Garrison about which playtests / private offerings should be used.	Today this is /offerings from GSSV. Somehow the UX client needs to get the list of playtest private offerings to log in and get the titles for.
P1	Clicking on a playtest link takes the user to an Xbox Gaming Endpoint (Bayside) to be able to stream the game	Success looks like having a flow that ensures the player gets logged in first (before revealing any details), and once logged in successfully shows the player details of the playtest / private game and allows streams to be successfully started
P3	Bastion / Garrison support	Stretch Goal: Currently xplaytest is supporting Garrison as the testing endpoint. Ideally Garrison / Bastion will support private offering playtests as well. In the playtest details page, there should be a button to 'stream now' that launches the streaming experience.
P3	Launch args for game (GSSV support and playtest portal?)	Creators should be able to configure launch arguments for the game as part of the link so that a nightly playtest can focus on a specific level, enable a dev mode, etc.
P3	Streaming Region / Touch controls / other streaming config	Xplaytest portal allows configuration of other private offering configuration parameters like streaming region, adding touch controls, etc.
P3	Xplaytest has a way to collect feedback from playtesters	Stretch Goal: can we funnel feedback from playtesters to the studio in a meaningful way? Have partner center / xplaytest collect this

Project Timeline

Here is a suggested breakdown of how you tackle those objectives, describing milestones and associated deliverables. This timeline also includes key internship checkpoints such as your Connect, which is a mid-way impact discussion with your manager to allow ample time for adjustments based on progress and feedback.

Weeks	Project Milestone Description	Category *	Deliverable
1-2	Onboarding and Welcome	Ramp up	Understand your project, get to know your team, and get set up to be productive especially with Agency
Week 2 Checkpoint	First Connect (6/2)	Impact Conversation	Connect
3-4	Design Doc and Prototyping / Manual Testing	Architecture and Design	Reviewed Design Doc of E2E work needed. Detailed Engineering Estimates established
5-7	Core Service Work	Implementation	Services work complete across: GSSV, xplaytest, CAS?, etc.
Week 6 Checkpoint	Week #6 Midpoint Connect (6/30)	Impact Conversation	Connect
8-10	Front End Work	Implementation	Bayside player updates xplaytest portal updates
Week 10 Checkpoint	Week #10 Final Connect (7/28)	Impact Conversation	Connect
11-12	Documentation, Metrics, Polish	Engineering Excellence	Dashboards, Monitors, TSGs etc.
Week 11-12 Presentation	Final Project Presentation (specific date to be coordinated by UR Champs)	Shareout	Presentation

First Steps

Whew! Now that you're familiar with your project, what's next? Here are some suggestions.

What could use more clarity?

We've worked hard to make the project clear, easy to understand, and to give you a sense of how to go about tackling it, but it's very easy to forget things that we just assume everyone knows that won't be obvious to somebody new. It's ok if things didn't make sense – write down your questions so you can clarify them with your manager. After all, it's hard to be successful when you don't understand what you're trying to accomplish!

What do you hope to learn this summer?

This summer isn't just about working on a project; it's about learning in ways that will help you with your future career. Your manager has listed some ideas of skills and areas that you likely will have a chance to grow in based on your team's focus areas and the project that you will be working on. Take some time to think through if you have any areas (both technical and not!) that you're particularly interested in, then talk about both sets with your manager so that you're on the same page about your interests and you can work together to find ways to give you useful opportunities. This is particularly useful as you start but is a valuable conversation to refresh every couple weeks as your internship evolves.

Skill	Opportunities to Exercise
AI Accelerated Ramp Up / Onboarding	Understanding many repositories and services quickly to come up to speed on the project
Micro Service Architecture and Systems Design (.NET)	Working across various services to make code changes that maintain resilience and functionality
Experimentation, Quick Iteration and Prototyping	Using AI and prototyping to quickly prove out what is working and not working with existing systems and how they can be modified to come together
Full Stack & Front end development (React, Tailwind)	Working on the playtest portal and player endpoints
Cross Team Collaboration	Working with GSSV and xPlayTest dev teams
Cross Functional Collaboration	Working with PM to understand requirements and coordinate work across teams
Working through ambiguity	Many possibilities exist for the project. Finding the best tradeoffs and plan of action will be critical to success
Detail oriented problem solving (edge cases)	Many possibilities exist for the project and with this comes many edge cases and situations that may need clarified and handled appropriately.

Key Contacts

Here is a list of people on the team that you will likely be working with regularly. Take some time to look them up and introduce yourself in the first couple weeks and familiarize yourself with when and how they can help you.

Email Alias	Role	Description
Brian Bowman	Intern Manager	Primary contact, project definition and commitment setting, feedback and Connects
Aditya Toney	Onboarding Buddy	Your initial point of contact to make sure that you're settled in and that everything is working.
Emma Park	Intern Mentor	Day-to-day support, helps access resources needed for the project, provides feedback to manager about progress
Jessie Masih	Administrative Assistant	Provides assistance with workplace resources – office setup, special needs, equipment, events, etc...
David Kushmerick Bec Lyons	Feature Team Leader	Accountable for the feature that this project fits into.
Anthony Keller Timi Bolaji Ashton Summer Chuy Galvan	Engineering Experts	Individual Contributors (ICs) familiar with the major components to be modified
Ellery Charlson	UR Champ	Your gaming representative to the internship program that can help with program-wide events and internship questions. This is a good person to reach out to if you have feedback about your internship or if you have any questions that your team can't help with.

Other useful resources

Additional resources that you will find useful – familiarize yourself with these and keep this around as a reference for your internship.

[Manager TODO: Adjust or add additional references as appropriate for your team. Don't forget to add the relevant resources to the onboarding forms in Employee Central as well. Delete this note when completed.]

Description	URL/Alias
Intern Web Site	https://microsoft.sharepoint.com/teams/MicrosoftInterns
Xbox SharePoint	https://aka.ms/Gaming
Agentic AI for Gaming	https://aka.ms/AgentX
Team Aliases	xbox-juno-dev
Team Website	
Related Specs	
Team Wiki and Documentation	https://dev.azure.com/microsoft/Xbox.Streaming/_wiki/wikis/Xbox.Streaming.wiki/327152/Xbox-Game-Streaming-Wiki xCloud Dev API Offering Guidelines - Overview
Team ADO	https://dev.azure.com/microsoft/Xbox/_sprints/taskboard/Juno/Xbox/26-4W20%20(Ends%205-22)/2W18%20(Ends%205-8)
Code Repositories	https://dev.azure.com/microsoft/Xbox.Streaming/_git/services.permissions/pullrequests?_a=mine https://dev.azure.com/microsoft/Xbox/_git/Xbox.JS/pullrequests?_a=mine

One last thing ...

For making it this far, the most important resource of all. Remember, you work in Xbox now – play some games and have some fun!

<https://aka.ms/StudiosTokens>